

never wake up crying because your daughter is 18 and you were busy working or away on business trips during the wonderful years of her youth.

On the other hand, when you retire young you limit the amount of money you can give your kids. They'll have to go to public schools whether they like it or not. I went to Occidental College and Stanford University, two of the finest private institutions in the country. Because my family lived in California and qualified for financial aid, California State scholarships and fellowships covered most of the cost. To cover the rest, during college and business school I worked at night and in the summer. But my mother went back to work and my father worked overtime to earn money to help me out. My parents gave me and my brothers and sister the gift of unconditional love. They taught us to laugh, take responsibility for our actions, and get things done. When I think back, those are the things I remember most. But they also worked to come up with a few bucks when I needed them. I remember that too.

In Providence last summer Vicki and I met Frank and Emily Winter and their three sons, ages 10, 8, and 6. Frank's a self-taught carpenter; Emily's a therapist. They were working full-time to keep their children in one of Providence's experimental private schools. They were pleased with the school. But they felt their children were growing up without them. Frank and Emily wanted to be a part of their boys' daily discoveries, not just to hear about them for a few minutes before bedtime. They wanted to be there when the boys came home from school, not just to call them on the phone to see how they were doing.

After many late-night discussions, Frank and Emily opted for bare-bones retirement (see chapter 11). They moved to a farm in a remote corner of Vermont. Now the children attend a two-room school rather than the modern experimental center that seemed to work so well in Providence. Frank and Emily walk the boys to school each morning. After school the